Best on three of four test sets; only Hishab leads, on FLEURS

Word error rate (%), lower is better: every model scored greedily with the same harness and normalizer. Blue: the lowest WER among rankable rows. Under each number: that model's WER minus ours, from a paired bootstrap (“tie” when the 95% interval includes zero).

	DL Sprint eval media speech	FLEURS read Wikipedia	Common Voice read, crowd	Kathbath read, crowd
Final model (ours) Whisper-medium, fine-tuned on 300 h, open	**11.2**	15.6	**10.1**	**10.3**
Hishab conformer large CTC, ~120M, CC-BY-NC	21.2 +10.0 ours better	**14.2** -1.4 ours worse	7.7 ‡ not ranked	8.3 ‡ not ranked
IndicConformer 600M AI4Bharat, multilingual; better head per set	28.1 +17.0 ours better	15.7 +0.1 tie	13.2 +3.1 ours better	10.6 ? not ranked
Team Villagers DL Sprint 4.0 finalist, Whisper (CTranslate2)	13.9 * not ranked	19.6 +4.0 ours better	15.6 +5.5 ours better	14.7 +4.4 ours better
zarifmahir21 Whisper-medium fine-tuned on DL Sprint-era data	8.5 * not ranked	20.1 +4.5 ours better	13.7 +3.6 ours better	14.5 +4.2 ours better
tugstugi, zero-shot our starting point, Whisper-medium	22.7 +11.5 ours better	21.5 +5.9 ours better	14.8 +4.7 ours better	14.8 +4.5 ours better

* trained on DL Sprint 4.0 data, which includes these recordings. ‡ trained on this corpus (model card). ? training data not stated; AI4Bharat built Kathbath. IndicConformer: the better of its CTC and RNN-T heads per set (its RNN-T decoder returns nothing on many clips over 15 s). Not shown: psdn-ai/bangla-asr, which writes case endings as separate words (WER 63–76%, CER 10–17%).